

Psalms 70

Make Haste, O God

Make haste, O God, to deliver me

KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 *Make haste, O God, to deliver me; make haste to help me, O LORD.*
- 2 *Let them be ashamed and confounded that seek after my soul: let them be turned backward, and put to confusion, that desire my hurt.*
- 3 *Let them be turned back for a reward of their shame that say, Aha, aha.*
- 4 *Let all those that seek thee rejoice and be glad in thee: and let such as love thy salvation say continually, Let God be magnified.*
- 5 *But I am poor and needy: make haste unto me, O God: thou art my help and my deliverer; O LORD, make no tarrying.*

2 · CONTEXT

A brief, urgent psalm nearly identical to the closing verses of Psalm 40 (13–17), functioning as its own short prayer for immediate rescue from those who mock the psalmist's affliction. Henry notes its repeated urgency ("make haste") twice in five verses, modeling prayer that does not pad requests with elaborate argument when danger is pressing.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-3

"Make haste, O God, to deliver me... Let them be ashamed and confounded that seek after my soul... Let them be turned back for a reward of their shame that say, Aha, aha." The plea is immediate and specific: reversal of shame onto those who mock his affliction with cruel taunts.

Verse 4-5

"Let all those that seek thee rejoice and be glad in thee... But I am poor and needy: make haste unto me, O God... O LORD, make no tarrying." The psalm balances communal joy for all seekers of God with the psalmist's own acute, personal urgency, closing exactly as it began—with an unresolved plea for speed.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Some prayers are rightly brief and urgent rather than elaborate; naming yourself honestly as "poor and needy" and asking God not to "tarry" is itself a complete, faithful prayer, even without immediate resolution in the text.

Application for life today.

In genuine crisis, do not feel you must construct a theologically elaborate prayer before God will listen—"make haste" is enough. Let honest neediness replace performing spiritual strength you don't currently feel. Hold together, as this psalm does, urgent personal plea and genuine joy for others who seek God, rather than letting your own need eclipse all other concern.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no "right length" answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. What situation right now calls for a simple, urgent "make haste, O God" rather than an elaborate prayer?

2. How comfortable are you admitting "I am poor and needy" honestly before God?

3. How can you hold together urgent personal need and genuine gladness for others who "seek" God, as verses 4–5 do?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).